



Leveraging Artificial Intelligence (AI) in a Pandemic

AI is playing an increasingly vital role in helping to tackle the global crisis that has arisen from the COVID-19 pandemic. The scope of services that can be provided by AI is wide. From diagnosis to prediction, from clearing doubts to assessing risks, from identification to the delivery of food and services, AI has an important role to play in a pandemic.

Artificial intelligence (AI), also known as machine intelligence, is acquired by computing machines in order to complete any task that requires human intelligence. With the help of free and open source software (FOSS) tools and using advanced AI hardware, it's possible to develop various AI products that can be used to manage a pandemic. In China, the COVID-19 outbreak was managed using various AI products and services.

During a pandemic, there is a need to develop special software to suit situations that are continuously evolving. The development cycle, as elaborated below, is a standard.

The collaborative development model

Developing any software including AI involves the designing and coding of various modules, which requires more than one software engineer, especially if it's a large project and needs to be completed in time. In such a case, a collaborative model of software development is useful. This is done by distributing the development activity among various people involved in the project. In this model, the development of software is done in five different stages.

In the beginning, the customer or end user expresses the need for particular software, and the responsibility for communicating with the user is assigned to some people involved in the project. After

